arXiv 2610.16757

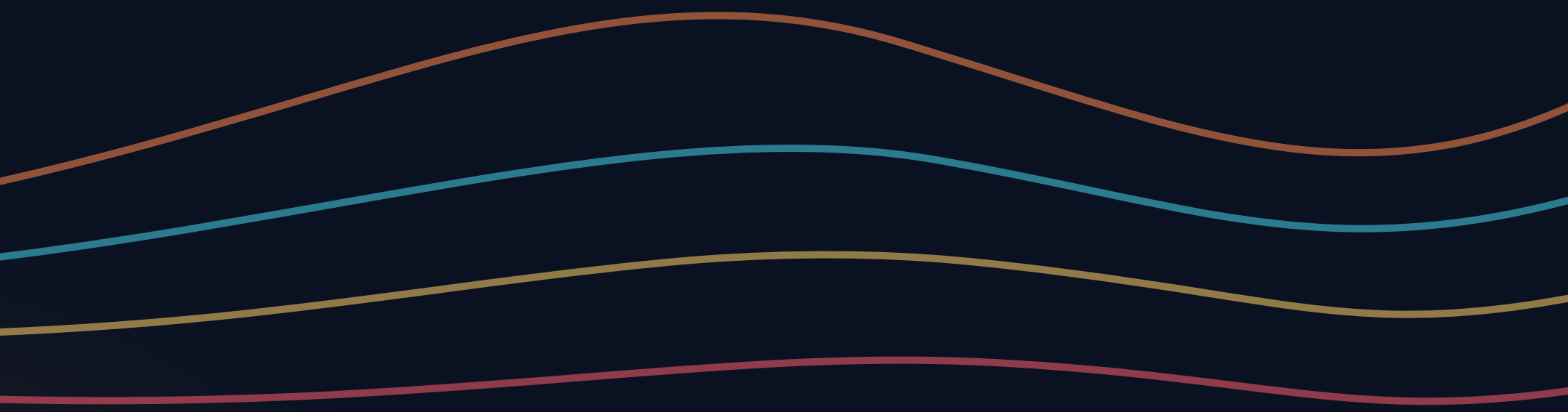
MY FIRST RESEARCH PAPER

Is the platform part of the measurement?

A protocol and simulation study for cross-platform equivalence of machine-labelled policy sentiment

Asad Ikram & **Dr Ella Haig**

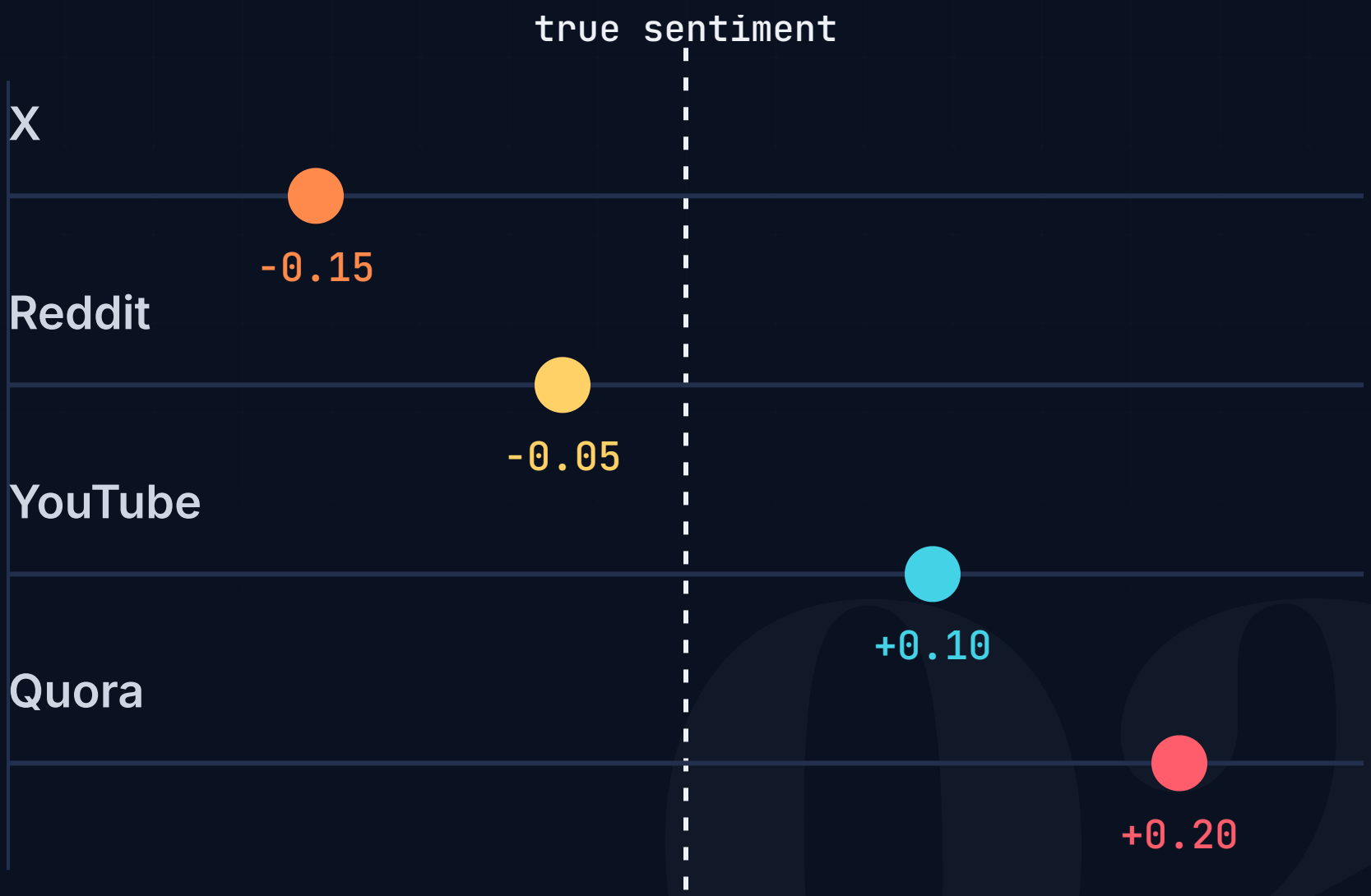
University of Portsmouth



Swipe →

Same opinion. Four different instruments.

We pool classifier scores across platforms and read the gap as a gap in opinion.



Each platform's affordance bias in the paper's simulation; it shifts what the classifier reads.

Treat each platform like a survey mode.

Survey researchers test whether phone and web questionnaires measure alike before comparing them. We bring that toolkit to machine-labelled text.

phone · web · in person → X · Reddit · YouTube · Quora

G

Generalizability theory

How much of the variance is the platform?

≡

Invariance & DIF

Does the instrument behave alike on each platform?

⇄

Score linking

Put every platform on one common scale.

2×

Two-classifier check

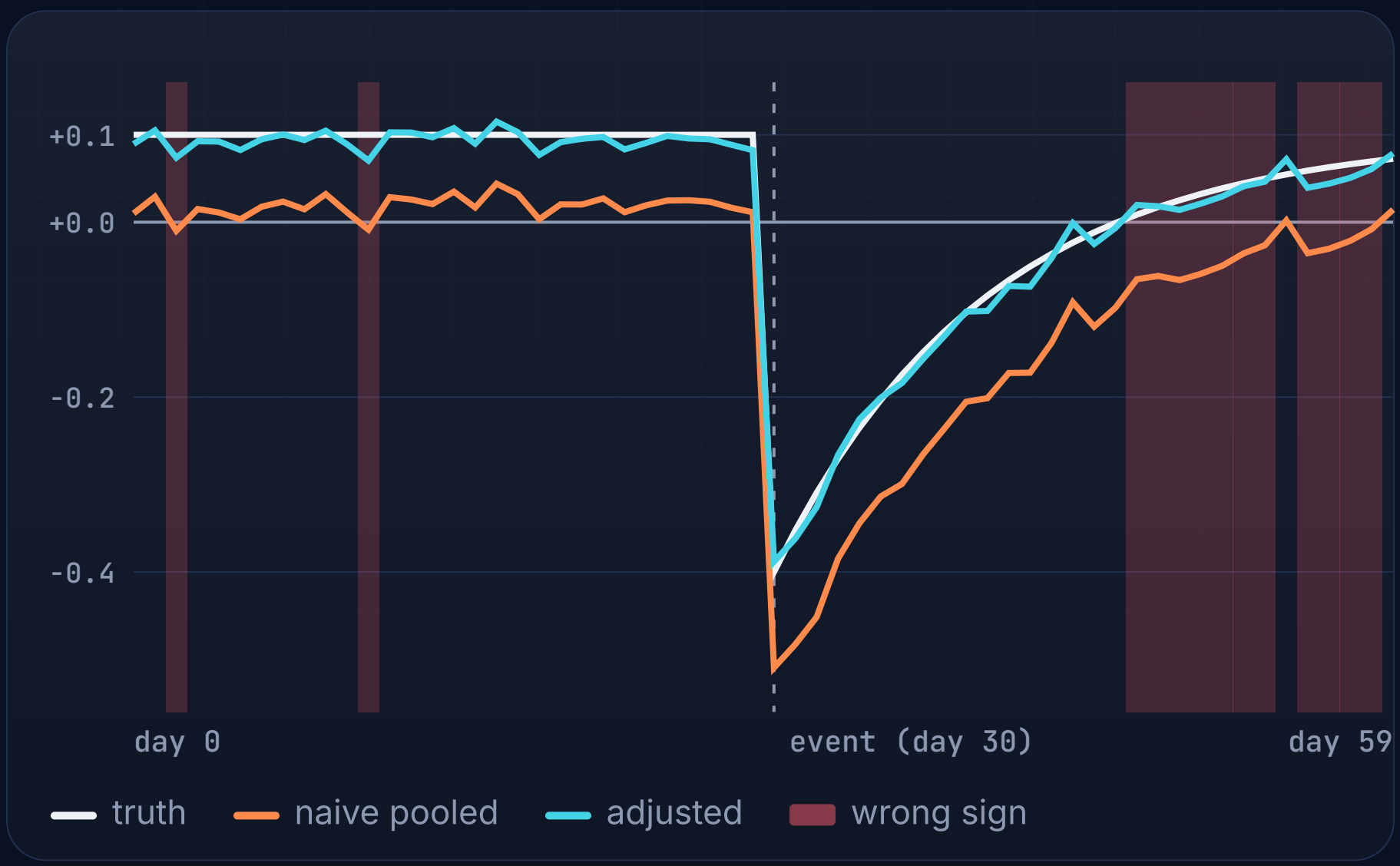
A platform effect must survive both models.

🇬🇧 Applied to **UK economic policy**: anchored on **15 UK fiscal-policy events**, from the 2020 Covid Budget onwards.

Six steps before you average.

1. **Same-event divergence**
   Do platforms really differ on the same event?
2. **Reliability per platform**
   A generalizability study against human labels
3. **Invariance and DIF**
   With the platform as the group
4. **Timing and composition**
   Adjust within anchor windows
5. **Score linking**
   Through anchor events fixed in advance
6. **The cost of assuming equivalence**
   Quantified in simulation, next slide →

Pool at face value and the index can point the wrong way.



13.8 / 60
days with the wrong sign, naive pooled index

0.8 / 60
days with the wrong sign, measurement-adjusted index

Means over 500 replications with known ground truth, one generating configuration. Chart: a single replication.

It began with a flaw in my own dissertation: a validation that turned out to be circular.

PAPER
arxiv.org/abs/2610.16757

OPEN CODE · RUNS IN A MINUTE
github.com/asadfix/platform-measurement

Feedback welcome, especially on measurement, LLM annotation and cross-platform data.

Looking for a PhD in computational social science · 2027

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